

- EVERY BOY'S LIBRARY -



*The Pied*  
PIPER OF HAMELIN

- EVERY BOY'S LIBRARY -



*The Pied*  
PIPER OF HAMELIN

## **The Project Gutenberg eBook of The Pied Piper of Hamelin, and Other Poems**

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org). If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: The Pied Piper of Hamelin, and Other Poems

Author: Robert Browning

Release date: May 30, 2013 [eBook #42850]

Most recently updated: October 23, 2024

Language: English

Other information and formats: [www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/42850](http://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/42850)

Credits: Produced by Juliet Sutherland, Paul Clark and the Online  
Distributed Proofreading Team at <http://www.pgdp.net>

**\*\*\* START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE PIED  
PIPER OF HAMELIN, AND OTHER POEMS \*\*\***

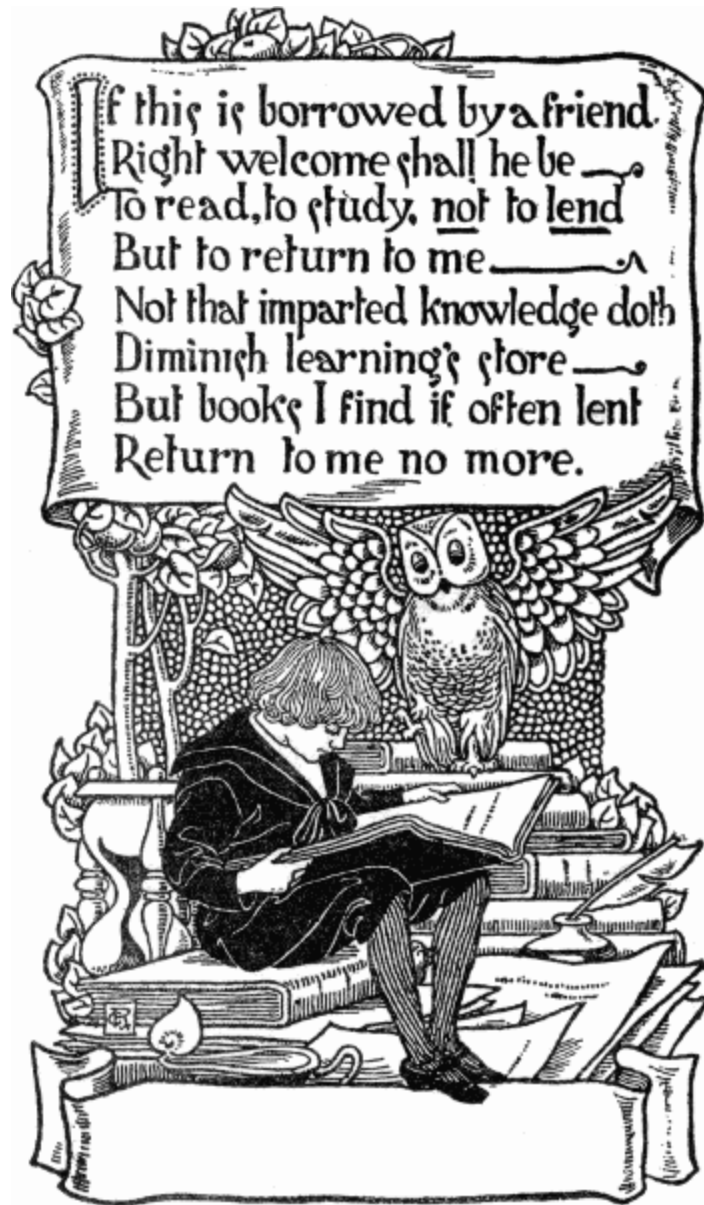
### Transcriber's Note:

Every effort has been made to replicate this text as faithfully as possible.

There is no Number 8 in the list of books in "Every Boy's Library".

Illustrations have been moved.

# The Pied Piper of Hamelin and Other Poems





# **Every Boy's Library**

**For Little Boys**

NEW EDITION, 1910

- 1 The Man Without a Country** By Rev. E. E. Hale
- 2 The Bicycle Highwaymen** By Frank M. Bicknell
- 3 The Railroad Cut** By W. O. Stoddard
- 4 J. Cole** By Emma Gellibrand
- 5 Laddie** By Evelyn Whitaker
- 6 Miss Toosey** By Evelyn Whitaker
- 7 Elder Leland's Ghost** By Hezekiah Butterworth
- 9 Wonder Book Stories** By Nathaniel Hawthorne
- 10 The Prince of the Pin Elves** By Charles Lee Sleight
- 11 The Little Lame Prince** By Miss Mulock
- 12 One Thousand Men for a Christmas Present** By Mary B. Sheldon
- 13 The Little Earl** By Ouida
- 14 The Double Prince** By Frank M. Bicknell
- 15 The Young Archer** By Charles E. Brimblecom
- 16 Little Peterkin Vandike** By Charles Stuart Pratt
- 17 Christmas Carol** By Charles Dickens
- 18 A Great Emergency** By Juliana Horatia Ewing
- 19 The Rose and the Ring** By William M. Thackeray
- 20 Lazy Lawrence and other Stories** By Maria Edgeworth
- 21 Forgive and Forget and Other Stories** By Maria Edgeworth
- 22 The False Key and other Stories** By Maria Edgeworth
- 23 A Boy's Battle** By Will Allen Dromgoole
- 24 The Cold Rug** By Edgar Allan Poe

**24 The Gold Bug** By Edgar Allan Poe

**25 The Pineboro Quartette** By Willis Boyd Allen

**26 His Majesty the King and Wee Willie Winkie** By Rudyard Kipling

**27 The Old Monday Farm** By Louise R. Baker

**28 Daddy Darwin's Dovecote** By Juliana H. Ewing

**29 Little Dick's Christmas** By Etheldred B. Barry

**30 What Paul Did** By Etheldred B. Barry

**31 Harum Scarum Joe** By Will Allen Dromgoole

**32 The Drums of the Fore and Aft** By Rudyard Kipling

**33 The Child of Urbino and Moufflou** By Ouida

**34 Hero-Chums** By Will Allen Dromgoole

**35 Little Tong's Mission** By Etheldred B. Barry

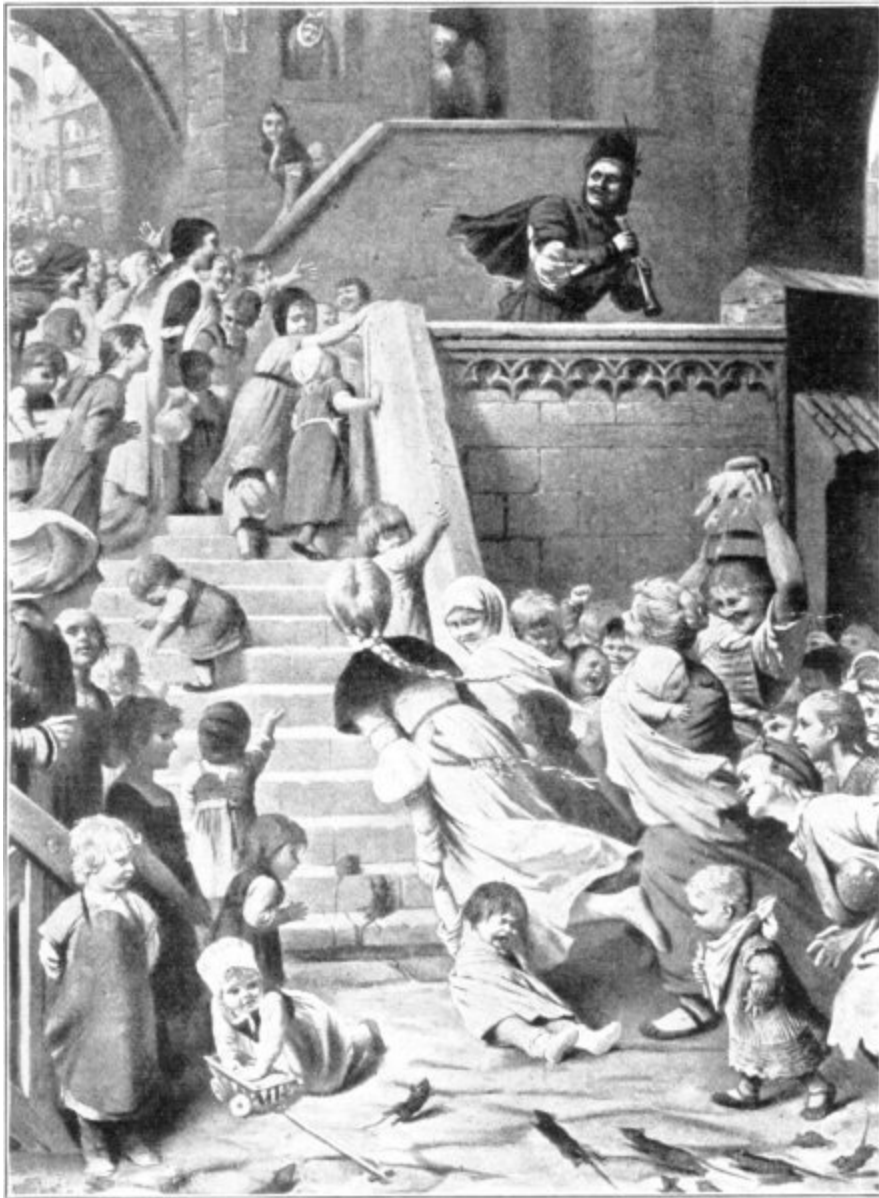
H. M. CALDWELL COMPANY

Publishers

NEW YORK AND BOSTON

---





**THE PIED PIPER OF HAMELIN**

---

EVERY BOY'S LIBRARY



THE PIED  
PIPER of  
HAMELIN  
and Other Poems

By  
ROBERT BROWNING



ILLUSTRATED

H. M. CALDWELL CO.  
PUBLISHERS     
NEW YORK & BOSTON

---

*Copyright, 1899*  
BY DANA ESTES & COMPANY

---

# CONTENTS.

|                                                                           | PAGE |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <a href="#"><u>THE PIED PIPER OF HAMELIN</u></a>                          | 11   |
| <a href="#"><u>HERVÉ RIEL</u></a>                                         | 24   |
| <a href="#"><u>CAVALIER TUNES</u></a>                                     | 31   |
| <a href="#"><u>“HOW THEY BROUGHT THE GOOD NEWS FROM GHENT TO AIX”</u></a> | 34   |
| <a href="#"><u>THROUGH THE METIDJA TO ABD-EL-KADR</u></a>                 | 37   |
| <a href="#"><u>INCIDENT OF THE FRENCH CAMP</u></a>                        | 39   |
| <a href="#"><u>CLIVE</u></a>                                              | 41   |
| <a href="#"><u>MULÉYKEH</u></a>                                           | 59   |
| <a href="#"><u>TRAY</u></a>                                               | 68   |
| <a href="#"><u>A TALE</u></a>                                             | 70   |
| <a href="#"><u>GOLD HAIR</u></a>                                          | 75   |
| <a href="#"><u>DONALD</u></a>                                             | 82   |
| <a href="#"><u>THE GLOVE</u></a>                                          | 90   |

---

# LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS.

|                                                                                        | PAGE                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| THE PIED PIPER OF HAMELIN                                                              | <a href="#"><i>Frontispiece</i></a> |
| “LEAVE TO GO AND SEE MY WIFE, WHOM I CALL THE BELLE<br>AURORE”                         | <a href="#">30</a>                  |
| “I GALLOPED, DIRCK GALLOPED, WE GALLOPED ALL THREE”                                    | <a href="#">34</a>                  |
| “A RIDER BOUND ON BOUND FULL GALLOPING, NOR BRIDLE DREW<br>UNTIL HE REACHED THE MOUND” | <a href="#">39</a>                  |
| “HAIR, SUCH A WONDER OF FLIX AND FLOSS”                                                | <a href="#">75</a>                  |
| “AND FULL IN THE FACE OF ITS OWNER FLUNG THE GLOVE”                                    | <a href="#">95</a>                  |

---

# **THE BOYS' BROWNING.**

# **THE PIED PIPER OF HAMELIN.**

**A CHILD'S STORY.**

## I

Hamelin Town's in Brunswick,  
By famous Hanover city;  
The river Weser, deep and wide,  
Washes its wall on the southern side;  
A pleasanter spot you never spied;  
But, when begins my ditty,  
Almost five hundred years ago,  
To see the townsfolk suffer so  
From vermin, was a pity.

## II

Rats!  
They fought the dogs and killed the cats,  
And bit the babies in the cradles,  
And ate the cheeses out of the vats,  
And licked the soup from the cooks' own ladles,  
Split open the kegs of salted sprats,  
Made nests inside men's Sunday hats,  
And even spoiled the women's chats  
By drowning their speaking  
With shrieking and squeaking  
In fifty different sharps and flats.

## III

At last the people in a body  
To the Town Hall came flocking:  
“’Tis clear,” cried they, “our Mayor’s a noddy;  
And as for our Corporation—shocking  
To think we buy gowns lined with ermine  
For dolts that can’t or won’t determine  
What’s best to rid us of our vermin!  
You hope, because you’re old and obese,

To find in the furry civic robe ease?  
Rouse up, sirs! Give your brains a racking  
To find the remedy we're lacking,  
Or, sure as fate, we'll send you packing!"

At this the Mayor and Corporation  
Quaked with a mighty consternation.

#### IV

An hour they sat in council;  
At length the Mayor broke silence:  
"For a guilder I'd my ermine gown sell,  
I wish I were a mile hence!  
It's easy to bid one rack one's brain—  
I'm sure my poor head aches again,  
I've scratched it so, and all in vain.  
Oh, for a trap, a trap, a trap!"

Just as he said this, what should hap  
At the chamber-door but a gentle tap?  
"Bless us," cried the Mayor, "what's that?"  
(With the Corporation as he sat,  
Looking little though wondrous fat;  
Nor brighter was his eye, nor moister  
Than a too-long-opened oyster,  
Save when at noon his paunch grew mutinous  
For a plate of turtle green and glutinous)  
"Only a scraping of shoes on the mat?  
Anything like the sound of a rat  
Makes my heart go pit-a-pat!"

#### V

"Come in!"—the Mayor cried, looking bigger:  
And in did come the strangest figure!  
His queer long coat from heel to head  
Was half of yellow and half of red,  
And he himself was tall and thin,  
With sharp blue eyes, each like a pin



with sharp blue eyes, each like a pin,  
And light loose hair, yet swarthy skin,  
No tuft on cheek nor beard on chin,  
But lips where smiles went out and in;  
There was no guessing his kith and kin:  
And nobody could enough admire  
The tall man and his quaint attire.  
Quoth one: "It's as my great-grandsire,  
Starting up at the Trump of Doom's tone,  
Had walked this way from his painted tombstone!"

## VI

He advanced to the council-table:  
And, "Please your honours," said he, "I'm able,  
By means of a secret charm, to draw  
All creatures living beneath the sun,  
That creep or swim or fly or run,  
After me so as you never saw!  
And I chiefly use my charm  
On creatures that do people harm,  
The mole and toad and newt and viper;  
And people call me the Pied Piper."  
(And here they noticed round his neck  
A scarf of red and yellow stripe,  
To match with his coat of the self-same cheque;  
And at the scarf's end hung a pipe;  
And his fingers, they noticed, were ever straying  
As if impatient to be playing  
Upon this pipe, as low it dangled  
Over his vesture so old-fangled.)  
"Yet," said he, "poor piper as I am,  
In Tartary I freed the Cham,  
Last June, from his huge swarms of gnats;  
I eased in Asia the Nizam  
Of a monstrous brood of vampire-bats:  
And as for what your brain bewilders,  
If I can rid your town of rats

Will you give me a thousand guilders?”  
“One? fifty thousand!”—was the exclamation  
Of the astonished Mayor and Corporation.

## VII

Into the street the Piper stept,  
Smiling first a little smile,  
As if he knew what magic slept  
In his quiet pipe the while;  
Then, like a musical adept,  
To blow the pipe his lips he wrinkled,  
And green and blue his sharp eyes twinkled,  
Like a candle-flame where salt is sprinkled;  
And ere three shrill notes the pipe uttered,  
You heard as if an army muttered;  
And the muttering grew to a grumbling;  
And the grumbling grew to a mighty rumbling;  
And out of the houses the rats came tumbling.  
Great rats, small rats, lean rats, brawny rats  
Brown rats, black rats, gray rats, tawny rats  
Grave old plodders, gay young friskers,  
Fathers, mothers, uncles, cousins,  
Cocking tails and pricking whiskers,  
Families by tens and dozens,  
Brothers, sisters, husbands, wives—  
Followed the Piper for their lives.  
From street to street he piped advancing,  
And step for step they followed dancing,  
Until they came to the river Weser,  
Wherein all plunged and perished!  
—Save one who, stout as Julius Cæsar,  
Swam across and lived to carry  
(As he, the manuscript he cherished)  
To Rat-land home his commentary:  
Which was, “At the first shrill notes of the pipe,  
I heard a sound as of scraping tripe,

And putting apples, wondrous ripe,  
Into a cider-press's gripe:  
And a moving away of pickle-tub-boards,  
And a leaving ajar of conserve-cupboards,  
And a drawing the corks of train-oil-flasks,  
And a breaking the hoops of butter-casks:  
And it seemed as if a voice  
(Sweeter far than by harp or by psaltery  
Is breathed) called out, 'Oh, rats, rejoice!  
The world is grown to one vast drysaltery!  
So munch on, crunch on, take your nuncheon,  
Breakfast, supper, dinner, luncheon!'  
And just as a bulky sugar-puncheon,  
All ready staved, like a great sun shone  
Glorious scarce an inch before me,  
Just as methought it said, 'Come, bore me!'  
—I found the Weser rolling o'er me."

## VIII

You should have heard the Hamelin people  
Ringing the bells till they rocked the steeple.  
"Go," cried the Mayor, "and get long poles,  
Poke out the nests and block up the holes!  
Consult with carpenters and builders,  
And leave in our town not even a trace  
Of the rats!"—when suddenly, up the face  
Of the Piper perked in the market-place,  
With a, "First, if you please, my thousand guilders!"

## IX

A thousand guilders! The Mayor looked blue;  
So did the Corporation, too.  
For council dinners made rare havoc  
With Claret, Moselle, Vin-de-Grave, Hock;  
And half the money would replenish  
Their cellar's hiddest butt with Rhenish

Then came a biggest butt with a thimble.

To pay this sum to a wandering fellow  
With a gypsy coat of red and yellow!  
“Beside,” quoth the Mayor with a knowing wink,  
“Our business was done at the river’s brink;  
We saw with our eyes the vermin sink,  
And what’s dead can’t come to life, I think.  
So, friend, we’re not the folks to shrink  
From the duty of giving you something for drink,  
And a matter of money to put in your poke;  
But as for the guilders, what we spoke  
Of them, as you very well know, was in joke.  
Beside, our losses have made us thrifty.  
A thousand guilders! Come, take fifty!”

## X

The Piper’s face fell, and he cried,  
“No trifling! I can’t wait, beside!  
I’ve promised to visit by dinner-time  
Bagdat, and accept the prime  
Of the Head-Cook’s pottage, all he’s rich in,  
For having left, in the Caliph’s kitchen,  
Of a nest of scorpions no survivor:  
With him I proved no bargain-driver,  
With you, don’t think I’ll bate a stiver!  
And folks who put me in a passion  
May find me pipe after another fashion.”

## XI

“How?” cried the Mayor, “d’ye think I brook  
Being worse treated than a Cook?  
Insulted by a lazy ribald  
With idle pipe and vesture piebald?  
You threaten us, fellow? Do your worst,  
Blow your pipe there till you burst!”

## XII

Once more he stept into the street,  
And to his lips again  
Laid his long pipe of smooth straight cane;  
And ere he blew three notes (such sweet  
Soft notes as yet musician's cunning  
Never gave the enraptured air)  
There was a rustling that seemed like a bustling  
Of merry crowds justling at pitching and hustling;  
Small feet were pattering, wooden shoes clattering,  
Little hands clapping and little tongues chattering,  
And, like fowls in a farmyard when barley is scattering,  
Out came the children running.  
All the little boys and girls,  
With rosy cheeks and flaxen curls,  
And sparkling eyes and teeth like pearls,  
Tripping and skipping, ran merrily after  
The wonderful music with shouting and laughter.

## XIII

The Mayor was dumb, and the Council stood  
As if they were changed into blocks of wood,  
Unable to move a step, or cry  
To the children merrily skipping by,  
—Could only follow with the eye  
That joyous crowd at the Piper's back.  
But how the Mayor was on the rack,  
And the wretched Council's bosoms beat,  
As the Piper turned from the High Street  
To where the Weser rolled its waters  
Right in the way of their sons and daughters!  
However, he turned from South to West,  
And to Koppelberg Hill his steps addressed,  
And after him the children pressed;  
Great was the joy in every breast.

“He never can cross that mighty top!  
He’s forced to let the piping drop,  
And we shall see our children stop!”  
When, lo, as they reached the mountainside,  
A wondrous portal opened wide,  
As if a cavern was suddenly hollowed;  
And the Piper advanced and the children followed,  
And when all were in to the very last,  
The door in the mountainside shut fast.  
Did I say, all? No! One was lame,  
And could not dance the whole of the way;  
And in after years, if you would blame  
His sadness, he was used to say,—  
“It’s dull in our town since my playmates left!  
I can’t forget that I’m bereft  
Of all the pleasant sights they see,  
Which the Piper also promised me.  
For he led us, he said, to a joyous land,  
Joining the town and just at hand,  
Where waters gushed and fruit-trees grew  
And flowers put forth a fairer hue,  
And everything was strange and new;  
The sparrows were brighter than peacocks here,  
And their dogs outran our fallow deer,  
And honey-bees had lost their stings,  
And horses were born with eagles’ wings:  
And just as I became assured  
My lame foot would be speedily cured,  
The music stopped and I stood still,  
And found myself outside the hill,  
Left alone against my will,  
To go now limping as before,  
And never hear of that country more!”

## XIV

Alas, alas for Hamelin!

There came into many a burgher’s nate

There came into many a stranger's path  
A text which says that heaven's gate  
Opes to the rich at as easy rate  
As the needle's eye takes a camel in!  
The Mayor sent East, West, North, and South,  
To offer the Piper, by word of mouth,  
Wherever it was men's lot to find him,  
Silver and gold to his heart's content,  
If he'd only return the way he went,  
And bring the children behind him.  
But when they saw 'twas a lost endeavour,  
And Piper and dancers were gone for ever,  
They made a decree that lawyers never  
Should think their records dated duly  
If, after the day of the month and year,  
These words did not as well appear,  
"And so long after what happened here  
On the Twenty-second of July,  
Thirteen hundred and seventy-six:"  
And the better in memory to fix  
The place of the children's last retreat,  
They called it, the Pied Piper's Street—  
Where any one playing on pipe or tabour  
Was sure for the future to lose his labour.  
Nor suffered they hostelry or tavern  
To shock with mirth a street so solemn;  
But opposite the place of the cavern  
They wrote the story on a column,  
And on the great church-window painted  
The same, to make the world acquainted  
How their children were stolen away,  
And there it stands to this very day.  
And I must not omit to say  
That in Transylvania there's a tribe  
Of alien people who ascribe  
The outlandish ways and dress  
On which their neighbours lay such stress,  
To their fathers and mothers having risen

Out of some subterraneous prison  
Into which they were trepanned  
Long time ago in a mighty band  
Out of Hamelin town in Brunswick land,  
But how or why, they don't understand.

## XV

So, Willy, let me and you be wipers  
Of scores out with all men—especially pipers!  
And, whether they pipe us free fróm rats or fróm mice,  
If we've promised them aught, let us keep our promise!

---



**HERVÉ RIEL.**

## I

On the sea and at the Hogue, sixteen hundred ninety-two,  
Did the English fight the French,—woe to France!  
And, the thirty-first of May, helter-skelter through the blue,  
Like a crowd of frightened porpoises a shoal of sharks pursue,  
Came crowding ship on ship to Saint Malo on the Rance,  
With the English fleet in view.

## II

'Twas the squadron that escaped, with the victor in full chase;  
First and foremost of the drove, in his great ship, Damfreville;  
Close on him fled, great and small,  
Twenty-two good ships in all;  
And they signalled to the place  
“Help the winners of a race!  
Get us guidance, give us harbour, take us quick—or, quicker still,  
Here's the English can and will!”

## III

Then the pilots of the place put out brisk and leapt on board;  
“Why, what hope or chance have ships like these to pass?” laughed they:  
“Rocks to starboard, rocks to port, all the passage scarred and scored,  
Shall the *Formidable* here with her twelve and eighty guns  
Think to make the river-mouth by the single narrow way,  
Trust to enter where 'tis ticklish for a craft of twenty tons,  
And with flow at full beside?  
Now, 'tis slackest ebb of tide.  
Reach the mooring? Rather say,  
While rock stands or water runs,  
Not a ship will leave the bay!”

## IV

Then was called a council straight.  
Brief and bitter the debate:  
“Here’s the English at our heels; would you have them take in tow  
All that’s left us of the fleet, linked together stern and bow,  
For a prize to Plymouth Sound?  
Better run the ships aground!”  
    (Ended Damfreville his speech.)  
“Not a minute more to wait!  
    Let the Captains all and each  
    Shove ashore, then blow up, burn the vessels on the beach!  
France must undergo her fate.

## V

“Give the word!” But no such word  
Was ever spoke or heard;  
For up stood, for out stepped, for in struck amid all these  
—A Captain? A Lieutenant? A Mate—first, second, third?  
    No such man of mark, and meet  
    With his betters to compete!  
    But a simple Breton sailor pressed by Tourville for the fleet,  
A poor coasting-pilot he, Hervé Riel the Croisickese.

## VI

And “What mockery or malice have we here?” cries Hervé Riel:  
    “Are you mad, you Malouins? Are you cowards, fools, or rogues?  
Talk to me of rocks and shoals, me who took the soundings, tell  
On my fingers every bank, every shallow, every swell  
    ’Twixt the offing here and Grève where the river disembogues?  
Are you bought by English gold? Is it love the lying’s for?  
    Morn and eve, night and day,  
    Have I piloted your bay,  
Entered free and anchored fast at the foot of Solidor.  
    Burn the fleet and ruin France? That were worse than fifty Hogues!  
    Sirs, they know I speak the truth! Sirs, believe me there’s a way!  
Only let me lead the line,

Have the biggest ship to steer,  
Get this *Formidable* clear,  
Make the others follow mine,  
And I lead them, most and least, by a passage I know well,  
Right to Solidor past Grève,  
And there lay them safe and sound;  
And if one ship misbehave,  
—Keel so much as grate the ground,  
Why, I've nothing but my life,—here's my head!" cries Hervé Riel.

## VII

Not a minute more to wait.  
"Steer us in, then, small and great!  
Take the helm, lead the line, save the squadron!" cried its chief.  
Captains, give the sailor place!  
He is Admiral, in brief.  
Still the north wind, by God's grace!  
See the noble fellow's face  
As the big ship, with a bound,  
Clears the entry like a hound,  
Keeps the passage as its inch of way were the wide sea's profound!  
See, safe through shoal and rock,  
How they follow in a flock,  
Not a ship that misbehaves, not a keel that grates the ground,  
Not a spar that comes to grief!  
The peril, see, is past,  
All are harboured to the last,  
And just as Hervé Riel hollas "Anchor!"—sure as fate,  
Up the English come—too late!

## VIII

So, the storm subsides to calm:  
They see the green trees wave  
On the heights o'erlooking Grève.  
Hearts that bled are stanch'd with balm.  
"Just our rapture to enhance

Just our capture to enhance,  
Let the English rake the bay,  
Gnash their teeth and glare askance  
As they cannonade away!  
'Neath rampired Solidor pleasant riding on the Rance!"  
How hope succeeds despair on each Captain's countenance!  
Out burst all with one accord,  
"This is Paradise for Hell!  
Let France, let France's King  
Thank the man that did the thing!"  
What a shout, and all one word,  
"Hervé Riel!"  
As he stepped in front once more,  
Not a symptom of surprise  
In the frank blue Breton eyes,  
Just the same man as before.

## IX

Then said Damfreville, "My friend,  
I must speak out at the end,  
Though I find the speaking hard.  
Praise is deeper than the lips:  
You have saved the King his ships,  
You must name your own reward.  
'Faith, our sun was near eclipse!  
Demand whate'er you will,  
France remains your debtor still.  
Ask to heart's content and have! or my name's not Damfreville."

## X

Then a beam of fun outbroke  
On the bearded mouth that spoke,  
As the honest heart laughed through  
Those frank eyes of Breton blue:  
"Since I needs must say my say,  
Since on board the duty's done,

And from Malo Roads to Croisic Point, what is it but a run?—  
Since 'tis ask and have, I may—  
Since the others go ashore—  
Come! A good whole holiday!  
Leave to go and see my wife, whom I call the Belle Aurore!”  
That he asked and that he got,—nothing more.

## XI

Name and deed alike are lost:  
Not a pillar nor a post  
In his Croisic keeps alive the feat as it befell;  
Not a head in white and black  
On a single fishing-smack,  
In memory of the man but for whom had gone to wrack  
All that France saved from the fight whence England bore the bell.  
Go to Paris: rank on rank  
Search the heroes flung pell-mell  
On the Louvre, face and flank!  
You shall look long enough ere you come to Hervé Riel.  
So, for better and for worse,  
Hervé Riel, accept my verse!  
In my verse, Hervé Riel, do thou once more  
Save the squadron, honour France, love thy wife the Belle Aurore!





**“LEAVE TO GO AND SEE MY WIFE, WHOM I CALL THE BELLE  
AURORE.”**

---



# **CAVALIER TUNES.**

## **I. MARCHING ALONG.**

Kentish Sir Byng stood for his King,  
Bidding the crop-headed Parliament swing:  
And, pressing a troop unable to stoop  
And see the rogues flourish and honest folk droop,  
Marched them along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song.

God for King Charles! Pym and such carles  
To the Devil that prompts 'em their treasonous parles!  
Cavaliers, up! Lips from the cup,  
Hands from the pasty, nor bite take nor sup  
Till you're—

CHORUS.—Marching along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song.

Hampden to hell, and his obsequies' knell.  
Serve Hazelrig, Fiennes, and young Harry as well!  
England, good cheer! Rupert is near!  
Kentish and loyalists, keep we not here,

CHO.—Marching along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song.

Then, God for King Charles! Pym and his snarls  
To the Devil that pricks on such pestilent carles!  
Hold by the right, you double your might;  
So, onward to Nottingham, fresh for the fight,

CHO.—March we along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song!

## II. GIVE A ROUSE.

King Charles, and who'll do him right now?  
King Charles, and who's ripe for fight now?  
Give a rouse: here's, in hell's despite now,  
King Charles!

Who gave me the goods that went since?  
Who raised me the house that sank once?  
Who helped me to gold I spent since?  
Who found me in wine you drank once?

CHO.—King Charles, and who'll do him right now?  
King Charles, and who's ripe for fight now?  
Give a rouse: here's, in hell's despite now,  
King Charles!

To whom used my boy George quaff else,  
By the old fool's side that begot him?  
For whom did he cheer and laugh else,  
While Noll's damned troopers shot him?

CHO.—King Charles, and who'll do him right now?  
King Charles, and who's ripe for fight now?  
Give a rouse: here's, in hell's despite now,  
King Charles!

### **III. BOOT AND SADDLE.**

Boot, saddle, to horse, and away!  
Rescue my castle before the hot day  
Brightens to blue from its silvery gray.

CHO.—“Boot, saddle, to horse, and away!”

Ride past the suburbs, asleep as you’d say;  
Many’s the friend there, will listen and pray  
“God’s luck to gallants that strike up the lay—

CHO.—“Boot, saddle, to horse, and away!”

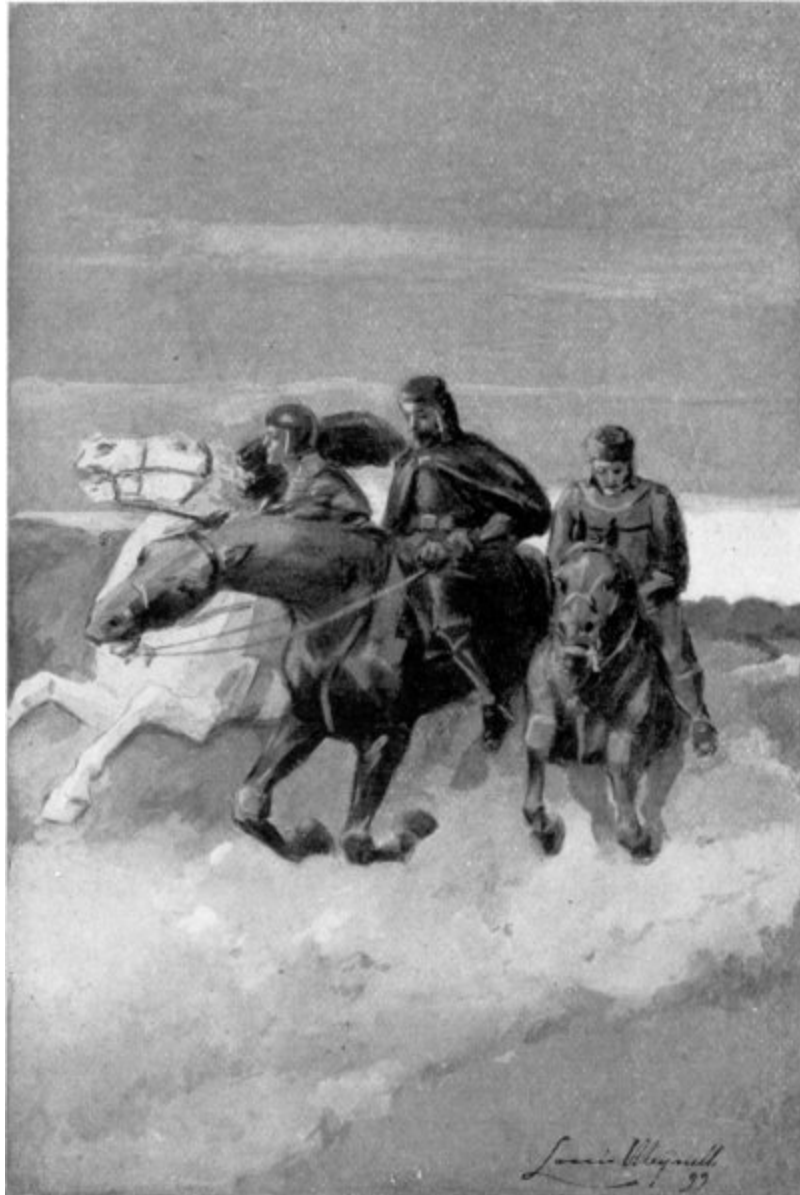
Forty miles off, like a roebuck at bay,  
Flouts Castle Brancepeth the Roundheads’ array:  
Who laughs, “Good fellows ere this, by my fay,

CHO.—“Boot, saddle, to horse, and away!”

Who? My wife Gertrude; that, honest and gay,  
Laughs when you talk of surrendering, “Nay!  
I’ve better counsellors; what counsel they?

CHO.—“Boot, saddle, to horse and away!”

---



**“I GALLOPED, DIRCK GALLOPED, WE GALLOPED ALL  
THREE.”**

**“HOW THEY BROUGHT THE GOOD NEWS  
FROM GHENT TO AIX.”**

I sprang to the stirrup, and Joris, and he;  
I galloped, Dirck galloped, we galloped all three;  
“Good speed!” cried the watch, as the gate-bolts undrew;  
“Speed!” echoed the wall to us galloping through;  
Behind shut the postern, the lights sank to rest,  
And into the midnight we galloped abreast.

Not a word to each other; we kept the great pace  
Neck by neck, stride by stride, never changing our place;  
I turned in my saddle and made its girths tight,  
Then shortened each stirrup, and set the pique right,  
Rebuckled the cheek-strap, chained slacker the bit,  
Nor galloped less steadily Roland a whit.

’Twas moonset at starting; but while we drew near  
Lokeren, the cocks crew and twilight dawned clear:  
At Boom, a great yellow star came out to see;  
At Düffeld, ’twas morning as plain as could be;  
And from Mecheln church-steeple we heard the half chime,  
So Joris broke silence with, “Yet there is time!”

At Aershot, up leaped of a sudden the sun,  
And against him the cattle stood black every one,  
To stare through the mist at us galloping past,  
And I saw my stout galloper Roland at last,  
With resolute shoulders, each butting away  
The haze, as some bluff river headland its spray:

And his low head and crest, just one sharp ear bent back  
For my voice, and the other pricked out on his track;  
And one eye’s black intelligence,—ever that glance  
O’er its white edge at me, his own master, askance!  
And the thick heavy spume-flakes which aye and anon  
His fierce lips shook upwards in galloping on.

By Hasselt, Dirck groaned; and cried Joris, “Stay spur!  
Your Roos galloped bravely, the fault’s not in her,

~~~~~

we'll remember at Aix"—for one heard the quick wheeze  
Of her chest, saw the stretched neck and staggering knees,  
And sunk tail, and horrible heave of the flank,  
As down on her haunches she shuddered and sank.  
So, we were left galloping, Joris and I,  
Past Looz and past Tongres, no cloud in the sky;  
The broad sun above laughed a pitiless laugh,  
'Neath our feet broke the brittle bright stubble like chaff;  
Till over by Dalhem a dome-spire sprang white,  
And "Gallop," gasped Joris, "for Aix is in sight!"

"How they'll greet us!" and all in a moment his roan  
Rolled neck and croup over, lay dead as a stone;  
And there was my Roland to hear the whole weight  
Of the news which alone could save Aix from her fate,  
With his nostrils like pits full of blood to the brim,  
And with circles of red for his eye-sockets' rim.

Then I cast loose my buffcoat, each holster let fall,  
Shook off both my jack-boots, let go belt and all,  
Stood up in the stirrup, leaned, patted his ear,  
Called my Roland his pet-name, my horse without peer;  
Clapped my hands, laughed and sang, any noise, bad or good,  
Till at length into Aix Roland galloped and stood.

And all I remember is—friends flocking round  
As I sat with his head, 'twixt my knees on the ground;  
And no voice but was praising this Roland of mine,  
As I poured down his throat our last measure of wine,  
Which (the burgesses voted by common consent)  
Was no more than his due who brought good news from Ghent.

---





**THROUGH THE METIDJA TO ABD-EL-KADR.**

As I ride, as I ride,  
With a full heart for my guide,  
So its tide rocks my side,  
As I ride, as I ride,  
That, as I were double-eyed,  
He, in whom our Tribes confide,  
Is descried, ways untried,  
As I ride, as I ride.

As I ride, as I ride  
To our Chief and his Allied,  
Who dares chide my heart's pride  
As I ride, as I ride?  
Or are witnesses denied—  
Through the desert waste and wide  
Do I glide unespied  
As I ride, as I ride?

As I ride, as I ride,  
When an inner voice has cried,  
The sands slide, nor abide  
(As I ride, as I ride)  
O'er each visioned homicide  
That came vaunting (has he lied?)  
To reside—where he died,  
As I ride, as I ride.

As I ride, as I ride,  
Ne'er has spur my swift horse plied,  
Yet his hide, streaked and pied,  
As I ride, as I ride,  
Shows where sweat has sprung and dried,  
—Zebra-footed, ostrich-thighed—  
How has vied stride with stride  
As I ride, as I ride!

As I ride, as I ride,  
-----

Could I loose what Fate has tied,  
Ere I pried, she should hide  
(As I ride, as I ride)  
All that's meant me—satisfied  
When the Prophet and the Bride  
Stop veins I'd have subside  
As I ride, as I ride!

---



**“A RIDER BOUND ON BOUND FULL GALLOPING, NOR BRIDLE  
DREW UNTIL HE REACHED THE MOUND.”**

## **INCIDENT OF THE FRENCH CAMP.**

You know, we French stormed Ratisbon:  
A mile or so away,  
On a little mound, Napoleon  
Stood on our storming-day;  
With neck out-thrust, you fancy how,  
Legs wide, arms locked behind,  
As if to balance the prone brow,  
Oppressive with its mind.

Just as perhaps he mused “My plans  
That soar, to earth may fall,  
Let once my army-leader, Lannes,  
Waver at yonder wall,—”  
Out ’twixt the battery-smokes there flew  
A rider, bound on bound  
Full-galloping; nor bridle drew  
Until he reached the mound.

Then off there flung in smiling joy,  
And held himself erect  
By just his horse’s mane, a boy:  
You hardly could suspect—  
(So tight he kept his lips compressed,  
Scarce any blood came through)  
You looked twice ere you saw his breast  
Was all but shot in two.

“Well,” cried he, “Emperor, by God’s grace  
We’ve got you Ratisbon!  
The Marshal’s in the market-place,  
And you’ll be there anon  
To see your flag-bird flap his vans  
Where I, to heart’s desire,  
Perched him!” The chief’s eye flashed; his plans  
Soared up again like fire.

The chief’s eye flashed; but presently

Softened itself, as sheathes  
A film the mother-eagle's eye  
When her bruised eaglet breathes;  
"You're wounded!" "Nay," the soldier's pride  
Touched to the quick, he said:  
"I'm killed, Sire!" and his chief beside,  
Smiling the boy fell dead.

---



**CLIVE.**

I and Clive were friends—and why not? Friends! I think you laugh, my lad.  
Clive it was gave England India, while your father gives—egad,  
England nothing but the graceless boy who lures him on to speak—  
“Well, Sir, you and Clive were comrades—” with a tongue thrust in your  
cheek!

Very true: in my eyes, your eyes, all the world’s eyes, Clive was man,  
I was, am, and ever shall be—mouse, nay, mouse of all its clan  
Sorriest sample, if you take the kitchen’s estimate for fame;  
While the man Clive—he fought Plassy, spoiled the clever foreign game,  
Conquered and annexed and Englished!

Never mind! As o’er my punch  
(You away) I sit of evenings,—silence, save for biscuit crunch,  
Black, unbroken,—thought grows busy, thrids each pathway of old years,  
Notes this forthright, that meander, till the long past life appears  
Like an outspread map of country plodded through, each mile and rood,  
Once, and well remembered still,—I’m startled in my solitude  
Ever and anon by—what’s the sudden mocking light that breaks  
On me as I slap the table till no rummer-glass but shakes  
While I ask—aloud, I do believe, God help me!—“Was it thus?  
Can it be that so I faltered, stopped when just one step for us—”  
(Us,—you were not born, I grant, but surely some day born would be)  
“—One bold step had gained a province” (figurative talk, you see)  
“Got no end of wealth and honour,—yet I stood stock-still no less?”  
—“For I was not Clive,” you comment: but it needs no Clive to guess  
Wealth were handy, honour ticklish, did no writing on the wall  
Warn me “Trespasser, ’ware man-traps!” Him who braves that notice—call  
Hero! None of such heroics suit myself who read plain words,  
Doff my hat, and leap no barrier. Scripture says, the land’s the Lord’s:  
Louts then—what avail the thousand, noisy in a smock-frocked ring,  
All-agog to have me trespass, clear the fence, be Clive their king?  
Higher warrant must you show me ere I set one foot before  
T’other in that dark direction, though I stand for evermore  
Poor as Job and meek as Moses. Evermore? No! By and by  
Job grows rich and Moses valiant, Clive turns out less wise than I.  
Don’t object “Why call him friend, then?” Power is power, my boy, and still  
Marks a man,—God’s gift magnific, exercised for good or ill.

You've your boot now on my hearth-rug, tread what was a tiger's skin;  
Rarely such a royal monster as I lodged the bullet in!  
True, he murdered half a village, so his own death came to pass;  
Still, for size and beauty, cunning, courage—ah, the brute he was!  
Why, that Clive,—that youth, that greenhorn, that quill-driving clerk, in  
fine,—  
He sustained a siege in Arcot ... But the world knows! Pass the wine.

Where did I break off at? How bring Clive in? Oh, you mentioned “fear!”  
Just so: and, said I, that minds me of a story you shall hear.

We were friends then, Clive and I: so, when the clouds, about the orb  
Late supreme, encroaching slowly, surely threaten to absorb  
Ray by ray its noontide brilliance,—friendship might, with steadier eye  
Drawing near, hear what had burned else, now no blaze—all majesty.  
Too much bee's-wing floats my figure? Well, suppose a castle's new:  
None presume to climb its ramparts, none find foothold sure for shoe  
'Twixt those squares and squares of granite plating the impervious pile  
As his scale-mail's warty iron cuirasses a crocodile.  
Reels that castle thunder-smitten, storm-dismantled? From without  
Scrambling up by crack and crevice, every cockney prates about  
Towers—the heap he kicks now! Turrets—just the measure of his cane!  
Will that do? Observe moreover—(same similitude again)—  
Such a castle seldom crumbles by sheer stress of cannonade:  
'Tis when foes are foiled, and fighting's finished that vile rains invade,  
Grass o'ergrows, o'ergrows till night-birds congregating find no holes  
Fit to build like the topmost sockets made for banner-poles.  
So Clive crumbled slow in London, crashed at last.

A week before,  
Dining with him,—after trying churchyard chat of days of yore,—  
Both of us stopped, tired as tombstones, head-piece, foot-piece, when they  
lean  
Each to other, drowsed in fog-smoke, o'er a coffined Past between.  
As I saw his head sink heavy, guessed the soul's extinguishment  
By the glazing eyeball, noticed how the furtive fingers went  
Where a drug-box skulked behind the honest liquor,—“One more throw  
Trv for Clive!” thought I: “Let's venture some good rattling question!” So

—  
“Come Clive, tell us”—out I blurted—“what to tell in turn, years hence,  
When my boy—suppose I have one—asks me on what evidence  
I maintain my friend of Plassy proved a warrior every whit  
Worth your Alexanders, Cæsars, Marlboroughs, and—what said Pitt?—  
Frederick the Fierce himself! Clive told me once”—I want to say—  
“Which feat out of all those famous doings bore the bell away  
—In his own calm estimation, mark you, not the mob’s rough guess—  
Which stood foremost as evincing what Clive called courageousness!  
Come! What moment of the minute, what speck-centre in the wide  
Circle of the action saw your mortal fairly deified?  
(Let alone that filthy sleep-stuff, swallow bold this wholesome Port!)  
If a friend has leave to question,—when were you most brave, in short?”

Up he arched his brows o’ the instant—formidably Clive again.  
“When was I most brave? I’d answer, were the instance half as plain  
As another instance that’s a brain-lodged crystal—curse it!—here  
Freezing when my memory touches—ugh!—the time I felt most fear.  
Ugh! I cannot say for certain if I showed fear—anyhow,  
Fear I felt, and, very likely, shuddered, since I shiver now.”

“Fear!” smiled I. “Well, that’s the rarer: that’s a specimen to seek,  
Ticket up in one’s museum, *Mind-Freaks, Lord Clive’s Fear, Unique!*”

Down his brows dropped. On the table painfully he pored as though  
Tracing, in the stains and streaks there, thoughts encrusted long ago.  
When he spoke ’twas like a lawyer reading word by word some will,  
Some blind jungle of a statement,—beating on and on until  
Out there leaps fierce life to fight with.

“This fell in my factor-days.  
Desk-drudge, slaving at Saint David’s, one must game, or drink, or craze.  
I chose gaming: and,—because your high-flown gamesters hardly take  
Umbrage at a factor’s elbow, if the factor pays his stake,—  
I was winked at in a circle where the company was choice,  
Captain This and Major That, men high of colour, loud of voice,  
Yet indulgent, condescending to the modest juvenile  
Who not merely risked, but lost his hard-earned guineas with a smile.

“Down I sat to cards, one evening,—had for my antagonist  
Homebody whose name’s a secret—you’ll know why—so, if you list,  
Call him Cock o’ the Walk, my scarlet son of Mars from head to heel!  
Play commenced: and, whether Cocky fancied that a clerk must feel  
Quite sufficient honour came of bending over one green baize,  
I the scribe with him the warrior, guessed no penman dared to raise  
Shadow of objection should the honour stay but playing end  
More or less abruptly,—whether disinclined he grew to spend  
Practice strictly scientific on a booby born to stare  
At—not ask of—lace-and-ruffles if the hand they hide plays fair,—  
Anyhow, I marked a movement when he bade me ‘Cut!’

“I rose.

‘Such the new manœuvre, Captain? I’m a novice: knowledge grows.  
What, you force a card, you cheat, Sir?’

“Never did a thunder-clap  
Cause emotion, startle Thyrsis locked with Chloe in his lap,  
As my word and gesture (down I flung my cards to join the pack)  
Fired the man of arms, whose visage, simply red before, turned black.

“When he found his voice, he stammered ‘That expression once again!’

“‘Well, you forced a card and cheated!’

“‘Possibly a factor’s brain,  
Busied with his all important balance of accounts, may deem  
Weighing words superfluous trouble: cheat to clerkly ears may seem  
Just the joke for friends to venture: but we are not friends, you see!  
When a gentleman is joked with,—if he’s good at repartee,  
He rejoins, as do I—Sirrah, on your knees, withdraw in full!  
Beg my pardon, or be sure a kindly bullet through your skull  
Lets in light and teaches manner to what brain it finds! Choose quick—  
Have your life snuffed out or, kneeling, pray me trim yon candle-wick!’

“‘Well, you cheated!’

“Then outbroke a howl from all the friends around

Then outbroke a howl from all the friends around.

To his feet sprang each in fury, fists were clenched and teeth were ground.  
'End it! no time like the present! Captain, yours were our disgrace!  
No delay, begin and finish! Stand back, leave the pair a space!  
Let civilians be instructed: henceforth simply ply the pen,  
Fly the sword! This clerk's no swordsman? Suit him with a pistol, then!  
Even odds! A dozen paces 'twixt the most and least expert  
Make a dwarf a giant's equal: nay, the dwarf, if he's alert,  
Likelier hits the broader target!'

"Up we stood accordingly.

As they handed me the weapon, such was my soul's thirst to try  
Then and there conclusions with this bully, tread on and stamp out  
Every spark of his existence, that,—crept close to, curled about  
By that toying, tempting, teasing, fool-forefinger's middle joint,—  
Don't you guess?—the trigger yielded. Gone my chance! and at the point  
Of such prime success moreover: scarce an inch above his head  
Went my ball to hit the wainscot. He was living, I was dead.

"Up he marched in flaming triumph—'twas his right, mind!—up, within  
Just an arm's length. 'Now, my clerkling,' chuckled Cocky, with a grin  
As the levelled piece quite touched me, 'Now, Sir Counting-House, repeat  
That expression which I told you proved bad manners! Did I cheat?'

"'Cheat you did, you knew you cheated, and, this moment, know as well.  
As for me, my homely breeding bids you—fire and go to Hell!'

"Twice the muzzle touched my forehead. Heavy barrel, flurried wrist.  
Either spoils a steady lifting. Thrice: then, 'Laugh at Hell who list,  
I can't! God's no fable either. Did this boy's eye wink once? No!  
There's no standing him and Hell and God all three against me,—so,  
I did cheat!'

"And down he threw the pistol, out rushed—by the door  
Possibly, but, as for knowledge if by chimney, roof or floor,  
He effected disappearance—I'll engage no glance was sent  
That way by a single starrer, such a blank astonishment  
Swallowed up their senses: as for speaking—mute they stood as mice.

“Mute not long, though! Such reaction, such a hubbub in a trice!  
‘Rogue and rascal! Who’d have thought it? What’s to be expected next,  
When His Majesty’s Commission serves a sharper as pretext  
For ... But where’s the need of wasting time now? Naught requires delay:  
Punishment the Service cries for: let disgrace be wiped away  
Publicly, in good broad daylight! Resignation? No, indeed!  
Drum and fife must play the Rogue’s-March, rank and file be free to speed  
Tardy marching on the rogue’s part by appliance in the rear  
—Kicks administered shall right this wronged civilian,—never fear,  
Mister Clive, for—though a clerk—you bore yourself—suppose we say—  
Just as would beseem a soldier?

“‘Gentlemen, attention—pray!

First, one word!’

“I passed each speaker severally in review.  
When I had precise their number, names, and styles, and fully knew  
Over whom my supervision thenceforth must extend,—why, then—

“Some five minutes since, my life lay—as you all saw, gentlemen—  
At the mercy of your friend there. Not a single voice was raised  
In arrest of judgment, not one tongue—before my powder blazed—  
Ventured “Can it be the youngster plundered, really seemed to mark  
Some irregular proceeding? We conjecture in the dark,  
Guess at random,—still, for sake of fair play—what if for a freak,  
In a fit of absence,—such things have been!—if our friend proved weak  
—What’s the phrase?—corrected fortune! Look into the case, at least!”  
Who dared interpose between the altar’s victim and the priest?  
Yet he spared me! You eleven! Whosoever, all or each,  
To the disadvantage of the man who spared me, utters speech  
—To his face, behind his back,—that speaker has to do with me:  
Me who promise, if positions change, and mine the chance should be,  
Not to imitate your friend and waive advantage!’

“Twenty-five

Years ago this matter happened: and ’tis certain,” added Clive,  
“Never, to my knowledge, did Sir Cocky have a single breath  
Breathed against him: lips were closed throughout his life, or since his

death,

For if he be dead or living I can tell no more than you.  
All I know is—Cocky had one chance more; how he used it,—grew  
Out of such unlucky habits, or relapsed, and back again  
Brought the late-ejected devil with a score more in his train,—  
That's for you to judge. Reprieval I procured, at any rate.  
Ugh—the memory of that minute's fear makes gooseflesh rise! Why prate  
Longer? You've my story, there's your instance: fear I did, you see!”

“Well”—I hardly kept from laughing—“if I see it, thanks must be  
Wholly to your Lordship's candour. Not that—in a common case—  
When a bully caught at cheating thrusts a pistol in one's face,  
I should under-rate, believe me, such a trial to the nerve!  
'Tis no joke, at one-and-twenty, for a youth to stand nor swerve.  
Fear I naturally look for—unless, of all men alive,  
I am forced to make exception when I come to Robert Clive.  
Since at Arcot, Plassy, elsewhere, he and death—the whole world knows—  
Came to somewhat closer quarters.”

Quarters? Had we come to blows,  
Clive and I, you had not wondered—up he sprang so, out he rapped  
Such a round of oaths—no matter! I'll endeavour to adapt  
To our modern usage words he—well, 'twas friendly license—flung  
At me like so many fire-balls, fast as he could wag his tongue.

“You—a soldier? You—at Plassy? Yours the faculty to nick  
Instantaneously occasion when your foe, if lightning-quick,  
—At his mercy, at his malice,—has you, through some stupid inch  
Undefended in your bulwark? Thus laid open,—not to flinch  
—That needs courage, you'll concede me. Then, look here! Suppose the  
man,

Checking his advance, his weapon still extended, not a span  
Distant from my temple,—curse him!—quietly had bade me, ‘There!  
Keep your life, calumniator!—worthless life I freely spare:  
Mine you freely would have taken—murdered me and my good fame  
Both at once—and all the better! Go, and thank your own bad aim  
Which permits me to forgive you!’ What if, with such words as these,  
He had cast away his weapon? How should I have borne me, please?



Nay, I'll spare you pains and tell you. This, and only this, remained—  
Pick his weapon up and use it on myself. If so had gained  
Sleep the earlier, leaving England probably to pay on still  
Rent and taxes for half India, tenant at the Frenchman's will."

"Such the turn," said I, "the matter takes with you? Then I abate  
—No, by not one jot nor tittle,—of your act my estimate.  
Fear—I wish I could detect there: courage fronts me, plain enough—  
Call it desperation, madness—never mind! for here's in rough  
Why, had mine been such a trial, fear had overcome disgrace.  
True, disgrace were hard to bear: but such a rush against God's face  
—None of that for me, Lord Plassy, since I go to church at times,  
Say the creed my mother taught me! Many years in foreign climes  
Rub some marks away—not all, though! We poor sinners reach life's brink,  
Overlook what rolls beneath it, recklessly enough, but think  
There's advantage in what's left us—ground to stand on, time to call  
'Lord, have mercy!' ere we topple over—do not leap, that's all!"

Oh, he made no answer, re-absorbed into his cloud. I caught  
Something like "Yes—courage; only fools will call it fear."

If aught

Comfort you, my great unhappy hero Clive, in that I heard,  
Next week, how your own hand dealt you doom, and uttered just the word  
"Fearfully courageous!"—this, be sure, and nothing else I groaned.  
I'm no Clive, nor parson either: Clive's worst deed—we'll hope condoned.

---



**MULÉYKEH.**

If a stranger passed the tent of Hóseyn, he cried “A churl’s!”  
Or haply “God help the man who has neither salt nor bread!”  
—“Nay,” would a friend exclaim, “he needs nor pity nor scorn  
More than who spends small thought on the shore-sand, picking pearls,  
—Holds but in light esteem the seed-sort, bears instead  
On his breast a moon-like prize, some orb which of night makes morn.

“What if no flocks and herds enrich the son of Sinán?  
They went when his tribe was mulct, ten thousand camels the due,  
Blood-value paid perforce for a murder done of old.  
‘God gave them, let them go! But never since time began,  
Muléykeh, peerless mare, owned master the match of you,  
And you are my prize, my Pearl: I laugh at men’s land and gold!’

“So in the pride of his soul laughs Hóseyn—and right, I say.  
Do the ten steeds run a race of glory? Outstripping all,  
Ever Muléykeh stands first steed at the victor’s staff.  
Who started, the owner’s hope, gets shamed and named, that day.  
‘Silence,’ or, last but one, is ‘The Cuffed,’ as we used to call  
Whom the paddock’s lord thrusts forth. Right, Hóseyn, I say, to laugh!”

“Boasts he Muléykeh the Pearl?” the stranger replies: “Be sure  
On him I waste nor scorn nor pity, but lavish both  
On Duhl the son of Sheybán, who withers away in heart  
For envy of Hóseyn’s luck. Such sickness admits no cure.  
A certain poet has sung, and sealed the same with an oath,  
‘For the vulgar—flocks and herds! The Pearl is a prize apart.’”

Lo, Duhl the son of Sheybán comes riding to Hóseyn’s tent,  
And he casts his saddle down, and enters and “Peace!” bids he.  
“You are poor, I know the cause: my plenty shall mend the wrong.  
’Tis said of your Pearl—the price of a hundred camels spent  
In her purchase were scarce ill paid: such prudence is far from me  
Who proffer a thousand. Speak! Long parley may last too long.”

Said Hóseyn, “You feed young beasts a many, of famous breed,  
Slit-eared, unblemished, fat, true offspring of Múzenem:

~~~~~

Here stumbles no weak-eyed she in the line as it climbs the hill.  
But I love Muléykeh's face: her forefront whitens indeed  
Like a yellowish wave's cream-crest. Your camels—go gaze on them!  
Her fetlock is foam-splashed too. Myself am the richer still.”

A year goes by: lo, back to the tent again rides Duhl.  
“You are open-hearted, ay—moist-handed, a very prince.  
Why should I speak of sale? Be the mare your simple gift!  
My son is pined to death for her beauty: my wife prompts ‘Fool,  
Beg for his sake the Pearl! Be God the rewarder, since  
God pays debts seven for one: who squanders on Him shows thrift.’”

Said Hóseyn, “God gives each man one life, like a lamp, then gives  
That lamp due measure of oil: lamp lighted—hold high, wave wide  
Its comfort for others to share! once quench it, what help is left?  
The oil of your lamp is your son: I shine while Muléykeh lives.  
Would I beg your son to cheer my dark if Muléykeh died?  
It is life against life: what good avails to the life-bereft?”

Another year, and—hist! What craft is it Duhl designs?  
He alights not at the door of the tent as he did last time,  
But, creeping behind, he gropes his stealthy way by the trench  
Half-round till he finds the flap in the folding, for night combines  
With the robber—and such is he: Duhl, covetous up to crime,  
Must wring from Hóseyn's grasp the Pearl, by whatever the wrench.

“He was hunger-bitten, I heard: I tempted with half my store,  
And a gibe was all my thanks. Is he generous like Spring dew?  
Account the fault to me who chaffered with such an one!  
He has killed, to feast chance comers, the creature he rode: nay, more—  
For a couple of singing-girls his robe has he torn in two:  
I will beg! Yet I nowise gained by the tale of my wife and son.

“I swear by the Holy House, my head will I never wash  
Till I filch his Pearl away. Fair dealing I tried, then guile,  
And now I resort to force. He said we must live or die:  
Let him die, then,—let me live! Be bold—but not too rash!  
I have found me a peeping-place: breast, bury your breathing while  
I explore for myself! Now, breathe! He deceived me not, the spy!

I explore for myself: now, breathe: he deceived me not, the spy:

“As he said—there lies in peace Hóseyn—how happy! Beside  
Stands tethered the Pearl: thrice winds her headstall about his wrist:  
'Tis therefore he sleeps so sound—the moon through the roof reveals.  
And, loose on his left, stands too that other, known far and wide,  
Buhéyseh, her sister born: fleet is she yet ever missed  
The winning tail's fire-flash a-stream past the thunderous heels.

“No less she stands saddled and bridled, this second, in case some thief  
Should enter and seize and fly with the first, as I mean to do.  
What then? The Pearl is the Pearl: once mount her we both escape.”  
Through the skirt-fold in glides Duhl,—so a serpent disturbs no leaf  
In a bush as he parts the twigs entwining a nest: clean through,  
He is noiselessly at his work: as he planned, he performs the rape.

He has set the tent-door wide, has buckled the girth, has clipped  
The headstall away from the wrist he leaves thrice bound as before,  
He springs on the Pearl, is launched on the desert like bolt from bow.  
Up starts our plundered man: from his breast though the heart be ripped,  
Yet his mind has the mastery: behold, in a minute more,  
He is out and off and away on Buhéyseh, whose worth we know!

And Hóseyn—his blood turns flame, he has learned long since to ride,  
And Buhéyseh does her part,—they gain—they are gaining fast  
On the fugitive pair, and Duhl has Ed-Dárraj to cross and quit,  
And to reach the ridge El-Sabán,—no safety till that he spied!  
And Buhéyseh is, bound by bound, but a horse-length off at last,  
For the Pearl has missed the tap of the heel, the touch of the bit.

She shortens her stride, she chafes at her rider the strange and queer:  
Buhéyseh is mad with hope—beat sister she shall and must,  
Though Duhl, of the hand and heel so clumsy, she has to thank.  
She is near now, nose by tail—they are neck by croup—joy! fear!  
What folly makes Hóseyn shout “Dog Duhl, Damned son of the Dust,  
Touch the right ear and press with your foot my Pearl's left flank!”

And Duhl was wise at the word, and Muléykeh as prompt perceived  
Who was urging redoubled pace, and to hear him was to obey,

And a leap indeed gave she, and vanished for evermore.  
And Hóseyn looked one long last look as who, all bereaved,  
Looks, fain to follow the dead so far as the living may:  
Then he turned Buhéyseh's neck slow homeward, weeping sore.

And, lo, in the sunrise, still sat Hóseyn upon the ground  
Weeping: and neighbours came, the tribesmen of Bénu-Asád  
In the vale of green Er-Rass, and they questioned him of his grief;  
And he told from first to last how, serpent-like, Duhl had wound  
His way to the nest, and how Duhl rode like an ape, so bad!  
And how Buhéyseh did wonders, yet Pearl remained with the thief.

And they jeered him, one and all: "Poor Hóseyn is crazed past hope!  
How else had he wrought himself his ruin, in fortune's spite?  
To have simply held the tongue were a task for boy or girl,  
And here were Muléykeh again, the eyed like an antelope,  
The child of his heart by day, the wife of his breast by night!"—  
"And the beaten in speed!" wept Hóseyn. "You never have loved my Pearl."

---

**TRAY.**



Sing me a hero! Quench my thirst  
Of soul, ye bards!

Quoth Bard the first:

“Sir Olaf, the good knight, did don  
His helm and eke his habergeon”...  
Sir Olaf and his bard—!

“That sin-scathed brow” (quoth Bard the second),  
“That eye wide ope as though Fate beckoned  
My hero to some steep, beneath  
Which precipice smiled tempting death”...  
You too without your host have reckoned!

“A beggar-child” (let’s hear this third!)  
“Sat on a quay’s edge: like a bird  
Sang to herself at careless play,  
And fell into the stream. ‘Dismay!  
Help, you the standers-by!’ None stirred.

“Bystanders reason, think of wives  
And children ere they risk their lives.  
Over the balustrade has bounced  
A mere instinctive dog, and pounced  
Plumb on the prize. ‘How well he dives!

““Up he comes with the child, see, tight  
In mouth, alive too, clutched from quite  
A depth of ten feet—twelve, I bet!  
Good dog! What, off again? There’s yet  
Another child to save? All right!

““How strange we saw no other fall!  
It’s instinct in the animal.  
Good dog! But he’s a long while under:  
If he got drowned I should not wonder—  
Strong current, that against the wall!

“Here he comes, holds in mouth this time  
—What may the thing be? Well, that’s prime!  
Now, did you ever? Reason reigns  
In man alone, since all Tray’s pains  
Have fished—the child’s doll from the slime!’

“And so, amid the laughter gay,  
Trotted my hero off,—old Tray,—  
Till somebody, prerogated  
With reason, reasoned: ‘Why he dived,  
His brain would show us, I should say.

“John, go and catch—or, if needs be,  
Purchase—that animal for me!  
By vivisection, at expense  
Of half-an-hour and eighteenpence,  
How brain secretes dog’s soul, we’ll see!’”

---

# A TALE.

What a pretty tale you told me  
Once upon a time  
—Said you found it somewhere (scold me!)  
Was it prose or was it rhyme,  
Greek or Latin? Greek, you said,  
While your shoulder propped my head.

Anyhow there's no forgetting  
This much if no more,  
That a poet (pray, no petting!)  
Yes, a bard, sir, famed of yore,  
Went where suchlike used to go,  
Singing for a prize, you know.

Well, he had to sing, nor merely  
Sing but play the lyre;  
Playing was important clearly  
Quite as singing: I desire,  
Sir, you keep the fact in mind  
For a purpose that's behind.

There stood he, while deep attention  
Held the judges round,  
—Judges able, I should mention,  
To detect the slightest sound  
Sung or played amiss: such ears  
Had old judges, it appears!

None the less he sang out boldly,  
Played in time and tune,  
Till the judges, weighing coldly  
Each note's worth, seemed, late or soon,  
Sure to smile "In vain one tries  
Picking faults out: take the prize!"

When, a mischief! Were they seven  
Strings the lyre possessed?

On, and afterwards eleven,  
Thank you! Well, sir,—who had guessed  
Such ill luck in store?—it happed  
One of those same seven strings snapped.

All was lost, then! No! a cricket  
(What “cicada?” Pooh!)  
—Some mad thing that left its thicket  
For mere love of music—flew  
With its little heart on fire,  
Lighted on the crippled lyre.

So that when (Ah, joy!) our singer  
For his truant string  
Feels with disconcerted finger,  
What does cricket else but fling  
Fiery heart forth, sound the note  
Wanted by the throbbing throat?

Ay, and ever to the ending,  
Cricket chirps at need,  
Executes the hand’s intending,  
Promptly, perfectly,—indeed  
Saves the singer from defeat  
With her chirrup low and sweet.

Till, at ending, all the judges  
Cry with one assent  
“Take the prize—a prize who grudges  
Such a voice and instrument?  
Why, we took your lyre for harp,  
So it shrilled us forth F sharp!”

Did the conqueror spurn the creature,  
Once its service done?  
That’s no such uncommon feature  
In the case when Music’s son  
Finds his Lotte’s power too spent  
For aiding soul-development

For aiding soul-development.

No! This other, on returning  
Homeward, prize in hand,  
Satisfied his bosom's yearning:  
(Sir, I hope you understand!)  
—Said "Some record there must be  
Of this cricket's help to me!"

So, he made himself a statue:  
Marble stood, life-size;  
On the lyre, he pointed at you,  
Perched his partner in the prize;  
Never more apart you found  
Her, he throned, from him, she crowned.

That's the tale: its application?  
Somebody I know  
Hopes one day for reputation  
Through his poetry that's—Oh,  
All so learned and so wise  
And deserving of a prize!

If he gains one, will some ticket,  
When his statue's built,  
Tell the gazer "'Twas a cricket  
Helped my crippled lyre, whose lilt  
Sweet and low, when strength usurped  
Softness' place i' the scale, she chirped?

"For as victory was nighest,  
While I sang and played,—  
With my lyre at lowest, highest,  
Right alike,—one string that made  
'Love' sound soft was snapt in twain,  
Never to be heard again,—

"Had not a kind cricket fluttered,  
Perched upon the place

Vacant left, and duly uttered  
    ‘Love, Love, Love,’ whene’er the bass  
Asked the treble to atone  
For its somewhat sombre drone.”

But you don’t know music! Wherefore  
    Keep on casting pearls  
To a—poet? All I care for  
    Is—to tell him that a girl’s  
“Love” comes aptly in when gruff  
Grows his singing. (There, enough!)

---



**“HAIR, SUCH A WONDER OF FLIX AND FLOSS.”**



**GOLD HAIR.**

Oh, the beautiful girl, too white,  
Who lived at Pornic, down by the sea,  
Just where the sea and the Loire unite!  
And a boasted name in Brittany  
She bore, which I will not write.

Too white, for the flower of life is red:  
Her flesh was the soft seraphic screen  
Of a soul that is meant (her parents said)  
To just see earth, and hardly be seen,  
And blossom in heaven instead.

Yet earth saw one thing, one how fair!  
One grace that grew to its full on earth:  
Smiles might be sparse on her cheek so spare,  
And her waist want half a girdle's girth,  
But she had her great gold hair.

Hair, such a wonder of flix and floss,  
Freshness and fragrance—floods of it, too!  
Gold, did I say? Nay, gold's mere dross:  
Here, Life smiled, "Think what I meant to do!"  
And Love sighed, "Fancy my loss!"

So, when she died, it was scarce more strange  
Than that, when delicate evening dies,  
And you follow its spent sun's pallid range,  
There's a shoot of colour startles the skies  
With sudden, violent change,—

That, while the breath was nearly to seek,  
As they put the little cross to her lips,  
She changed; a spot came out on her cheek,  
A spark from her eye in mid-eclipse,  
And she broke forth, "I must speak!"

"Not my hair!" made the girl her moan—  
"All the rest is gone or to go."

All the rest is gone or to go,  
But the last, last grace, my all, my own,  
Let it stay in the grave, that the ghosts may know!  
Leave my poor gold hair alone!”

The passion thus vented, dead lay she;  
Her parents sobbed their worst on that;  
All friends joined in, nor observed degree:  
For indeed the hair was to wonder at,  
As it spread—not flowing free,

But curled around her brow, like a crown,  
And coiled beside her cheeks, like a cap,  
And calmed about her neck—ay, down  
To her breast, pressed flat, without a gap  
I’ the gold, it reached her gown.

All kissed that face, like a silver wedge  
’Mid the yellow wealth, nor disturbed its hair:  
E’en the priest allowed death’s privilege,  
As he planted the crucifix with care  
On her breast, ’twixt edge and edge.

And thus was she buried, inviolate  
Of body and soul, in the very space  
By the altar; keeping saintly state  
In Pornic church, for her pride of race,  
Pure life and piteous fate.

And in after-time would your fresh tear fall,  
Though your mouth might twitch with a dubious smile,  
As they told you of gold, both robe and pall,  
How she prayed them leave it alone awhile,  
So it never was touched at all.

Years flew; this legend grew at last  
The life of the lady; all she had done,  
All been, in the memories fading fast  
Of lover and friend, was summed in one

Sentence survivors passed:

To wit, she was meant for heaven, not earth;  
Had turned an angel before the time:  
Yet, since she was mortal, in such dearth  
Of frailty, all you could count a crime  
Was—she knew her gold hair's worth.

---

At little pleasant Pornic church,  
It chanced, the pavement wanted repair,  
Was taken to pieces: left in the lurch,  
A certain sacred space lay bare,  
And the boys began research.

'Twas the space where our sires would lay a saint,  
A benefactor,—a bishop, suppose,  
A baron with armour-adornments quaint,  
Dame with chased ring and jewelled rose,  
Things sanctity saves from taint;

So we come to find them in after-days  
When the corpse is presumed to have done with gauds  
Of use to the living, in many ways:  
For the boys get pelf, and the town applauds,  
And the church deserves the praise.

They grubbed with a will: and at length—*O cor*  
*Humanum, pectora cæca*, and the rest!—  
They found—no gaud they were prying for,  
No ring, no rose, but—who would have guessed?—  
A double Louis-d'or!

Here was a case for the priest: he heard,  
Marked, inwardly digested, laid  
Finger on nose, smiled, "There's a bird  
Chimney-sweep!" then "Birds are not dead."

Curps in my ear:—then, “Bring a spade,  
Dig deeper!”—he gave the word.

And lo, when they came to the coffin-lid,  
Or rotten planks which composed it once,  
Why, there lay the girl’s skull wedged amid  
A mint of money, it served for the nonce  
To hold in its hair-heaps hid!

Hid there? Why? Could the girl be wont  
(She the stainless soul) to treasure up  
Money, earth’s trash and heaven’s affront?  
Had a spider found out the communion-cup,  
Was a toad in the christening-font?

Truth is truth: too true it was.  
Gold! She hoarded and hugged it first,  
Longed for it, leaned o’er it, loved it—alas—  
Till the humour grew to a head and burst,  
And she cried, at the final pass,—

“Talk not of God, my heart is stone!  
Nor lover nor friend—be gold for both!  
Gold I lack; and, my all, my own,  
It shall hide in my hair. I scarce die loth  
If they let my hair alone!”

Louis-d’or, some six times five,  
And duly double, every piece.  
Now, do you see? With the priest to shrive,  
With parents preventing her soul’s release  
By kisses that kept alive,—

With heaven’s gold gates about to ope,  
With friends’ praise, gold-like, lingering still,  
An instinct had bidden the girl’s hand grope  
For gold, the true sort—“Gold in heaven, if you will;  
But I keep earth’s too, I hope.”

Enough! The priest took the grave's grim yield:  
The parents, they eyed that price of sin  
As if *thirty pieces* lay revealed  
On the place *to bury strangers in*,  
The hideous Potter's Field.

But the priest bethought him: "'Milk that's spilt'  
—You know the adage! Watch and pray!  
Saints tumble to earth with so slight a tilt!  
It would build a new altar; that, we may!"  
And the altar therewith was built.

Why I deliver this horrible verse?  
As the text of a sermon, which now I preach:  
Evil or good may be better or worse  
In the human heart, but the mixture of each  
Is a marvel and a curse.

The candid incline to surmise of late  
That the Christian faith proves false, I find;  
For our Essays-and-Reviews' debate  
Begins to tell on the public mind,  
And Colenso's words have weight:

I still, to suppose it true, for my part,  
See reasons and reasons; this, to begin:  
'Tis the faith that launched point-blank her dart  
At the head of a lie—taught Original Sin,  
The Corruption of Man's Heart.

---



**DONALD.**



Do you happen to know in Ross-shire  
Mount Ben ... but the name scarce matters:  
Of the naked fact I am sure enough,  
Though I clothe it in rags and tatters.

You may recognise Ben by description;  
Behind him—a moor's immenseness:  
Up goes the middle mount of a range,  
Fringed with its firs in denseness.

Rimming the edge, its fir-fringe, mind!  
For an edge there is, though narrow;  
From end to end of the range, a strip  
Of path runs straight as an arrow.

And the mountaineer who takes that path  
Saves himself miles of journey  
He has to plod if he crosses the moor  
Through heather, peat, and burnie.

But a mountaineer he needs must be,  
For, look you, right in the middle  
Projects bluff Ben—with an end in *ich*—  
Why planted there, is a riddle:

Since all Ben's brothers little and big  
Keep rank, set shoulder to shoulder,  
And only this burliest out must bulge  
Till it seems—to the beholder

From down in the gully,—as if Ben's breast,  
To a sudden spike diminished,  
Would signify to the boldest foot  
“All further passage finished!”

Yet the mountaineer who sidles on  
And on to the very bending,  
Discovers if heart and brain be proof

Discovers, if heart and brain be proof,  
No necessary ending.

Foot up, foot down, to the turn abrupt  
Having trod, he, there arriving,  
Finds—what he took for a point was breadth  
A mercy of Nature's contriving.

So, he rounds what, when 'tis reached, proves straight,  
From one side gains the other:  
The wee path widens—resume the march,  
And he foils you, Ben my brother!

But Donald—(that name, I hope, will do)—  
I wrong him if I call “foiling”  
The tramp of the callant, whistling the while  
As blithe as our kettle's boiling.

He had dared the danger from boyhood up,  
And now,—when perchance was waiting  
A lass at the brig below,—'twixt mount  
And moor would he standing debating?

Moreover this Donald was twenty-five,  
A glory of bone and muscle:  
Did a fiend dispute the right of way,  
Donald would try a tussle.

Lightsomely marched he out of the broad  
On to the narrow and narrow;  
A step more, rounding the angular rock,  
Reached the front straight as an arrow.

He stepped it, safe on the ledge he stood,  
When—whom found he full-facing?  
What fellow in courage and wariness too,  
Had scouted ignoble pacing,

And left low safety to timid mates,

And made for the dread dear danger,  
And gained the height where—who could guess  
He would meet with a rival ranger?

'Twas a gold-red stag that stood and stared,  
Gigantic and magnific,  
By the wonder—ay, and the peril—struck  
Intelligent and pacific:

For a red deer is no fallow deer  
Grown cowardly through park-feeding;  
He batters you like a thunderbolt  
If you brave his haunts unheeding.

I doubt he could hardly perform *volte-face*  
Had valour advised discretion:  
You may walk on a rope, but to turn on a rope  
No Blondin makes profession.

Yet Donald must turn, would pride permit,  
Though pride ill brooks retiring:  
Each eyed each—mute man, motionless beast—  
Less fearing than admiring.

These are the moments when quite new sense,  
To meet some need as novel,  
Springs up in the brain: it inspired resource:  
—“Nor advance nor retreat but—grovel!”

And slowly, surely, never a whit  
Relaxing the steady tension  
Of eye-stare which binds man to beast,—  
By an inch and inch declension,

Sank Donald sidewise down and down:  
Till flat, breast upwards, lying  
At his six-foot length, no corpse more still,  
—“If he cross me! The trick’s worth trying.”

Minutes were an eternity;  
But a new sense was created  
In the stag's brain too; he resolves! Slow, sure,  
With eye-stare unabated,

Feelingly he extends a foot  
Which tastes the way ere it touches  
Earth's solid and just escapes man's soft,  
Nor hold of the same unclutches

Till its fellow foot, light as a feather whisk,  
Lands itself no less finely:  
So a mother removes a fly from the face  
Of her babe asleep supinely.

And now 'tis the haunch and hind-foot's turn  
—That's hard: can the beast quite raise it?  
Yes, traversing half the prostrate length,  
His hoof-tip does not graze it.

Just one more lift! But Donald, you see,  
Was sportsman first, man after:  
A fancy lightened his caution through,  
—He wellnigh broke into laughter:

“It were nothing short of a miracle!  
Unrivalled, unexampled—  
All sporting feats with this feat matched  
Were down and dead and trampled!”

The last of the legs as tenderly  
Follows the rest: or never  
Or now is the time! His knife in reach,  
And his right hand loose—how clever!

For this can stab up the stomach's soft,  
While the left hand grasps the pastern.  
A rise on the elbow, and—now's the time

Or never: this turn's the last turn!

I shall dare to place myself by God  
Who scanned—for he does—each feature  
Of the face thrown up in appeal to him  
By the agonising creature.

Nay, I hear plain words: “Thy gift brings this!”  
Up he sprang, back he staggered,  
Over he fell, and with him our friend  
—At following game no laggard.

Yet he was not dead when they picked next day  
From the gully's depth the wreck of him;  
His fall had been stayed by the stag beneath  
Who cushioned and saved the neck of him.

But the rest of his body—why, doctors said,  
Whatever could break was broken;  
Legs, arms, ribs, all of him looked like a toast  
In a tumbler of port wine soaken.

“That your life is left you, thank the stag!”  
Said they when—the slow cure ended—  
They opened the hospital door, and thence  
—Strapped, spliced, main fractures mended,

And minor damage left wisely alone,—  
Like an old shoe clouted and cobbled,  
Out—what went in a Goliath wellnigh,—  
Some half of a David hobbled.

“You must ask an alms from house to house:  
Sell the stag's head for a bracket,  
With its grand twelve tines—I'd buy it myself—  
And use the skin for a jacket!”

He was wiser, made both head and hide  
His win-penny: hands and knees on,

Would manage to crawl—poor crab—by the roads  
In the misty stalking season.

And if he discovered a bothy like this,  
Why, harvest was sure: folk listened.  
He told his tale to the lovers of Sport:  
Lips twitched, cheeks glowed, eyes glistened.

And when he had come to the close, and spread  
His spoils for the gazers' wonder,  
With "Gentlemen, here's the skull of the stag  
I was over, thank God, not under!"—

The company broke out in applause;  
"By Jingo, a lucky cripple!  
Have a munch of grouse and a hunk of bread,  
And a tug, besides, at our tipples!"

And "There's my pay for your pluck!" cried This,  
"And mine for your jolly story!"  
Cried That, while T'other—but he was drunk—  
Hiccapped "A trump, a Tory!"

I hope I gave twice as much as the rest;  
For, as Homer would say, "within grate  
Though teeth kept tongue," my whole soul growled,  
"Rightly rewarded,—Ingrate!"

---





**“AND FULL IN THE FACE OF ITS OWNER FLUNG THE GLOVE.”**



# THE GLOVE.

(PETER RONSARD *loipuitur.*)

“Heigho,” yawned one day King Francis,  
“Distance all value enhances!  
When a man’s busy, why, leisure  
Strikes him as wonderful pleasure:  
‘Faith, and at leisure once is he?  
Straightway he wants to be busy.  
Here we’ve got peace; and aghast I’m  
Caught thinking war the true pastime.  
Is there a reason in metre?  
Give us your speech, master Peter!”  
I who, if mortal dare say so,  
Ne’er am at a loss with my Naso,  
“Sire,” I replied, “joys prove cloudlets:  
Men are the merest Ixions”—  
Here the King whistled aloud, “Let’s  
—Heigho—go look at our lions!”  
Such are the sorrowful chances  
If you talk fine to King Francis.

And so, to the courtyard proceeding  
Our company, Francis was leading,  
Increased by new followers tenfold  
Before he arrived at the penfold;  
Lords, ladies, like clouds which bedizen  
At sunset the western horizon.  
And Sir De Lorge pressed ’mid the foremost  
With the dame he professed to adore most.  
Oh, what a face! One by fits eyed  
Her, and the horrible pitside;  
For the penfold surrounded a hollow  
Which led where the eye scarce dared follow,  
And shelved to the chamber secluded  
Where Bluebeard, the great lion, brooded.  
The King hailed his keeper, an Arab  
As glossy and black as a scarab,  
And bade him make sport and at once stir  
Up and out of his den the old monster.

They opened a hole in the wire-work  
Across it, and dropped there a firework,  
And fled: one's heart's beating redoubled;  
A pause, while the pit's mouth was troubled,  
The blackness and silence so utter,  
By the firework's slow sparkling and sputter;  
Then earth in a sudden contortion  
Gave out to our gaze her abortion.  
Such a brute! Were I friend Clement Marot  
(Whose experience of nature's but narrow,  
And whose faculties move in no small mist  
When he versifies David the Psalmist)  
I should study that brute to describe you  
*Illum Juda Leonem de Tribu.*

One's whole blood grew curdling and creepy  
To see the black mane, vast and heapy,  
The tail in the air stiff and straining,  
The wide eyes, nor waxing nor waning,  
As over the barrier which bounded  
His platform, and us who surrounded  
The barrier, they reached and they rested  
On space that might stand him in best stead:  
For who knew, he thought, what the amazement,  
The eruption of clatter and blaze meant,  
And if, in this minute of wonder,  
No outlet, 'mid lightning and thunder,  
Lay broad, and, his shackles all shivered,  
The lion at last was delivered?  
Ay, that was the open sky o'erhead!  
And you saw by the flash on his forehead,  
By the hope in those eyes wide and steady.  
He was leagues in the desert already,  
Driving the flocks up the mountain,  
Or catlike couched hard by the fountain  
To waylay the date-gathering negress:  
So guarded he entrance or egress.  
"How he stands!" quoth the King: "we may well swear

\*\*\* END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE PIED PIPER  
OF HAMELIN, AND OTHER POEMS \*\*\*

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

# THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at [www.gutenberg.org/license](http://www.gutenberg.org/license).

## **Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works**

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the

collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with

this eBook or online at [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org). If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official

version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website ([www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org)), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.



- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

#### 1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES

EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a)

distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

## **Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg**

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org).

## **Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation**

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact

links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at [www.gutenberg.org/contact](http://www.gutenberg.org/contact)

## **Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation**

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit [www.gutenberg.org/donate](http://www.gutenberg.org/donate).

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: [www.gutenberg.org/donate](http://www.gutenberg.org/donate).

## **Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works**

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org).

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.